

The Passive in All Tenses

CEFR B2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Every passive is be + past participle. Change only the 'be' part:

- 1** Simple tenses — is done / was done / will be done.
- 2** Perfect tenses — has been done / had been done.
- 3** Continuous — is being done / was being done.
- 4** Modals — must be done / can be done.

The past participle stays the same in every case. Only 'be' carries the tense or modal.

At a glance

Tense	Active	Passive
Present simple	They make it.	It is made .
Past simple	They made it.	It was made .
Present continuous	They are making it.	It is being made .
Past continuous	They were making it.	It was being made .
Present perfect	They have made it.	It has been made .
Past perfect	They had made it.	It had been made .
Future (will)	They will make it.	It will be made .
Modal	They must make it.	It must be made .

Learning objectives

- Can form the passive in simple, perfect, continuous and modal structures (CEFR B2).
- Can keep the past participle constant while changing only 'be'.
- Can avoid the awkward continuous-perfect passives.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. The Passive in All Tenses · CEFR B2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. Present continuous: The bridge ____ at the moment.

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------------|
| A. is repaired | B. is being repaired |
| C. is repairing | D. has been repaired |

2. Present perfect: The parcels ____ already.

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------------|
| A. have delivered | B. have been delivered |
| C. are delivered | D. were delivered |

3. Modal: This bottle ____ .

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| A. can recycle | B. can be recycled |
| C. can be recycle | D. is can recycled |

4. Past perfect: By the time we arrived, the room ____ .

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------------|
| A. had cleaned | B. had been cleaned |
| C. was cleaning | D. has been cleaned |

5. Past continuous: When I called, my car ____ .

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| A. was repaired | B. was being repaired |
| C. is being repaired | D. had been repaired |

6. Future: The results ____ next week.

- | | |
|---------------------|----------------------|
| A. will announce | B. will be announced |
| C. will be announce | D. are announced |

7. Correct this: 'The report must completed by Friday.'

- | | |
|--|--|
| A. The report must be completed by Friday. | B. The report must completed by Friday. |
| C. The report must be complete by Friday. | D. The report must been completed by Friday. |

8. Present simple: Millions of emails ____ every second.

- | | |
|----------------|--------------|
| A. send | B. are sent |
| C. are sending | D. have sent |

9. Present perfect (singular): The decision ____ .

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------|
| A. have been made | B. has been made |
| C. has made | D. was been made |

10. Which passive form is best avoided as too clumsy?

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| A. It is being built. | B. It will be being built. |
| C. It has been built. | D. It was built. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. is being repaired** — Continuous passive = is being + participle: 'is being repaired'.
2. **B. have been delivered** — Present perfect passive = have been + participle: 'have been delivered'.
3. **B. can be recycled** — Modal passive = modal + be + participle: 'can be recycled'.
4. **B. had been cleaned** — Past perfect passive = had been + participle: 'had been cleaned'.
5. **B. was being repaired** — Past continuous passive = was being + participle: 'was being repaired'.
6. **B. will be announced** — Future passive = will be + participle: 'will be announced'.
7. **A. The report must be completed by Friday.** — Modal passive = modal + be + participle: 'must be completed'.
8. **B. are sent** — Present passive = are + participle: 'are sent'.
9. **B. has been made** — 'has been made' — present perfect passive, singular subject.
10. **B. It will be being built.** — 'Will be being built' (future continuous passive) is clumsy — rephrase.